

fires at gas stations. But, both the Cellular Telecommunications Industry Association (CTIA) and the American Petroleum Institute issued statements denying the risk.

The CTIA said, "There is no evidence whatsoever that a wireless phone has ever caused ignition or explosion at a station anywhere in the world. Wireless phones don't cause gas stations to blow up. Warnings being posted in petrol stations simply perpetuate the myth." The American Petroleum Institute said, "We can find no evidence of someone using a cellphone causing any kind of accident, no matter how small, at a gas station anywhere in the world."

Still, many reports circulated the Net which mentioned persons who were getting their cars refueled and talking on their mobile phone suffered burns and injuries as the fumes got ignited. In some cases, cars and entire petrol pumps were alleged to having been destroyed. Well, it's better to be safe than sorry, as we mentioned earlier, mobile phones should not be used around other flammable or explosive materials.

Connectivity Concerns

Most mobile users in India still do not get uninterrupted 24x7 connectivity. There are certain areas where the network coverage is excellent, some areas where it is just about OK, and other areas where it is non-existent. The reasons could be multiple - it could depend on the services of the cellular provider, or the handset, or the location. With Wi-Fi seeing increased penetration and coverage, and being a relatively inexpensive technology, connectivity issues should reduce: hybrid phones let people make connections using a local wireless Internet access point and seamlessly switch over to a cell phone network when necessary.

Moreover, cellular carriers are also upgrading their systems for high-speed data. With short-range, high-speed Internet access and cellular service coming together, users will have better connectivity.